Team Contract

Project: "Routed" - A travel partner recommendation system
Class: ECE 651 - Foundations of Software Engineering
Group No: 15

A. Discuss Team Leadership & Communication:

1. **Team Leadership/Roles:**
   Discuss the best approach to establishing roles and leadership. Will it work best with one, consistent individual? Shared leadership? Or should you rotate leadership throughout?

   Our team will use a shared leadership approach. While one person may take the lead for specific tasks or meetings, responsibilities will be distributed based on individual strengths and availability. This approach allows everyone to stay involved, encourages accountability, and ensures that leadership does not rest on a single person throughout the project.

2. **Decision---making: How will the team come to a decision? by consensus? by unanimous agreement? How will you ensure all perspectives and ideas are heard equally?**

   Decisions will be made primarily through group discussion and consensus. Each team member will be encouraged to share their ideas and opinions during meetings. If there are differing viewpoints, we will discuss them openly and work toward a solution that the majority agrees on. This ensures that all perspectives are considered and everyone feels heard before final decisions are made.

3. **Submissions: How will group--- oriented aspects of the project be managed (who is in charge of what)? Who is res ponsible for submitting milestones/deliverables?**

   Group-oriented tasks will be divided clearly among team members at the beginning of each milestone, with roles assigned based on interest and skill set. One designated team member will be responsible for compiling and submitting the final deliverables, ensuring that deadlines are met and submissions are consistent. However, all team members will review the work before submission to maintain quality and accuracy.

4. **Preferred method of (informal) communication** (e.g., e-mail, phone, text, in person):

	Team Member Name	Email	Telephone or Other Co ntact Info	Preferred mode of Contact
1	Hemang Sood	h3sood@uwaterloo.ca	+1 (647) 466-0805	mail
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3	Karthi Elayaperumal Sampath	kelayape@uwaterloo.ca	+1 (647) 628-2438	mail
4	Barun Gnanasekaran	bgnanase@uwaterloo.ca	+1 (226) 899-5830	mail
5	Chao Liu	c724liu@uwaterloo.ca	+1 (548) 990-5500	mail

B. Establish Team Meeting Norms/Expectations:

1. **Day, time, place and frequency for regular (formal) team meetings**:
   Every week Wed after lecture(11:30 am)

2. **Punctuality and participation at team meetings.**
   It's important for the team that the expectations are set clearly for team meetings. This includes agreeing on guidelines such as allowing only one person to speak at a time, listening to understand rather than to respond, thus keeping the session interactive. Also every member is expected to be presented on time and should mention their availability well in advance and the organizer should maintain MOM. It is also expected that everyone turns their mobile phones off.

3. **Method for setting and following meeting agenda and note taking.**
   Determine whether to include roundtable progress and roadblock updates, brainstorming time, time to critique works in progress, rotating roles at meetings, etc.

   Who will set each agenda? When? How will team members contribute to the agenda? Who will be responsible for ensuring the team follows the agenda during a team meeting?)

   One of the team members will be assigned as a project manager and they will set the planned agenda well in advance(at least 24 hours before). The agenda for the week will be drafted by each member mentioning what they want to discuss and a consolidated agenda will be set by the project manager. Each member can contribute to the agenda(as a shared doc) and add if any critical items that need to be discussed as a high priority. The meeting organiser will be the meeting lead and ensure that the meeting is effective and every detail is discussed within time.

   Who will be responsible for recording and disseminating meeting minutes? How and when will the minutes be disseminated? Where will all agendas and minutes be stored?

   Meeting times will be communicated through the group chat or via email if a team member is unavailable. The agenda and meeting summaries will be maintained in Google Docs, so that all the team members can contribute to and review the documents.

4. **Procedures in the absence of a team member:**
   (Will the team meet with one member absent, or must all members be present? Who takes responsibility for updating the absent member? How will meeting minutes be shared, by whom?)
   The team member should inform well in advance if they can't attend. All the members are expected to attend. If a member is absent, one designated team member (such as the meeting lead)will be responsible for updating them. Meeting minutes, recordings(if any) will be documented in a shared Google Docs folder and communicated to the absent member via the group chat or email.

C. Discuss Team and Individual Expectations:
What are the team's expectations with regards to:

1. Desired grade or goal for the project.

It's important to have a conversation during the first meeting to lay out each person's expectations and priorities. Once you know personal goals, as a group you can determine an overall goal for the project. For example, do you hope to achieve an 80% on this project or do you not necessarily care about the grade but want to focus on exploring and developing something really creative (which may be riskier in terms of grades).

Our primary goal is to achieve a grade of 85% or higher. We know this would require us to do sufficient research to improve the quality of our report and presentation, as well as asking feedback from our advisor early and often. We agree that this needs effective teamwork and high-quality deliverables.

Also, we want to explore creative solutions and deepen our practical knowledge of:

Web development tools (e.g., React, FastAPI)

Dev tools (e.g., VS Code, Git)

CI/CD tools (e.g. Docker, Github Actions)

SDLC

Hopefully, we will attain our expected grade while developing a robust project with agile development strategy and modern toolchains.

2. Expectations for completing assignments and meeting deadlines.

Discuss each of your study habits and past teamwork experiences. Do you expect to start an assignment early and have consistent milestones or do you tend to procrastinate and complete everything closer to the due date?

We will break down large assignments and projects into smaller tasks, with each task designed to be completed by an individual within one or two days . We will frequently review everyone's schedules and set reasonable internal deadlines for all group members. A shared workspace, such as Google Docs or GitLab, will be maintained to ensure everyone has easy access to the most up-to-date task schedule. Tasks will be assigned based on individual availability, strengths, and interests, and each member is responsible for contributing to the project. Hopefully, we will use a group chat to discuss task arrangements, track progress and millstones, and address any roadblocks while seeking solutions together.

D.Managing Team Challenges and Conflict

Discuss your preferences for receiving feedback about your performance. If a conflict arises with a team member, address the issue with them directly. If a solution is not reached, involve another team member (or third party) in a follow up conversation. Involving the instructor should be the last resort. Describe how the team will approach a teammate who has not fulfilled an expectation/task? Who will address the issue with the individual? Will you offer support/help? How?

Team members prefer to receive feedback through direct and constructive feedback sessions focused on tasks and outcomes. Conflicts will be addressed first through direct confrontation and collaboration, followed by compromise if needed.

If unresolved, a neutral team member will mediate the issue, with escalation to the instructor as a last resort. When a team member fails to meet expectations, the Project Manager or a neutral member will address the issue directly and offer support such as clarification, assistance, or task adjustment.

If infractions with this teammate continue, what are the consequences? Will someone take over their part of the project? Will they receive a reduced grade (this will be dependent upon the instructor)?

As a last resort, we will document the lack of contribution. The consequence of continued infractions will be an honest Peer Evaluation at the end of the semester, which might lead to a grade adjustment by the instructor. Our priority is to ensure the project stays on track while being fair to every contributing member.

E. Other Considerations

Other tenants or agreements that your team has agreed are important to agree upon

Intellectual Property and Tools: All team members agree to use a shared GitLab repository for code and a shared Google Drive for all project-related documentation.

Code Review Standards: Team members are expected to review peer's code before merging into the master branch.All team members are required to follow the basic code submission procedure.

Team spirit: Be nice to others and cheer when needed.

Certification by team members:

In appending your signatures below, you are stating that:

a) You participated in formulating the standards, roles, and procedures of this contract;

b) You have agreed to abide by these terms and conditions of this contract

Signatures:

1. Hemang Sood
2. Madhav Srinath Thangaivel
3. Karthi Elayaperumal Sampath
4. Barun Gnanasekaran
5. Chao Liu